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TAB 19



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson, Ms. Goldberg - Exploring Incorporating Financial Literacy into the LAUSD Curriculum (Res 024-23/24) (For Action April 9, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has a responsibility to ensure students are able to meet their lives' challenges through grade school and beyond;

Whereas, Only 27% of California high school students have access to personal financial literacy classes;

Whereas, California's high cost of living has left families facing difficult decisions regarding finances, with the state ranking in the top 10 in terms of debt;

Whereas, The rising cost of tuition at The California State University System is set to rise 5% every year for the next five years for a total of a 25% increase, increasing the need for borrowing amount;

Whereas, Predatory and unlawful financial practices burden low-income communities and trap families with inescapable debt;

Whereas, Low-income and communities of color suffer the most from bank deserts, communities with limited or no banking institutions, that pressure their residents to rely on payday lenders or other companies that offer money loans with high-interest rates;

Whereas, Studies show that the borrowing amount, annual percentage rate, or rejection of a loan has been historically tied to systemic racism, also known as redlining, resulting in harsher loan terms for minority communities despite having similar financial outcomes as their non-minority counterparts;

Whereas, Low-income and communities of color have fewer opportunities to establish generational wealth, with Hispanic communities having a median household income of \$62,800 and African-American communities holding \$52,860 in median household income, below the national median of \$74,580 according to a 2022 United States Census Bureau report;

Whereas, Multiple student surveys conducted by government and non-profit entities report the highest concern about college amongst high school seniors is how to pay for it and not being able to afford their dream schools;

Whereas, In 2021, the District launched the Opportunity LA program, a free college savings program for first-grade students; and

Whereas, Financial literacy is provided to all high school seniors and their families at certain schools through specific courses, at specific schools, and through family academy; now, therefore, it be

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recommends that the Superintendent or a designee explore incorporating financial literacy throughout the current curriculum, such as English, mathematics, history, civics, economics, and government classes;

Resolved further, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will develop curriculum that is adapted to the needs and lived experience of children from low-income and housing cost-burdened households, with a primary focus on understanding specific aspects of personal financial management such as understanding credit and debt, avoiding predatory financial arrangements and institutions, and understanding structural factors that influence household finances including wages, job benefits, unions, and social welfare programs;

Resolved further, That this curriculum should be based on best practices from those the District schools that currently provide financial literacy learning options, and should also rely on approaches that have been demonstrated to have the most benefit for the diverse communities that make up the District student population;

Resolved further, That the District will assist students in the core concepts including, but not limited to, budgeting, borrowing, interest rates, banking and credit unions, taxes, retirement planning, and identity theft, among others;

Resolved further, That the District will work with community-based organizations and nonprofits to develop professional development that trains teachers how to effectively present financial literacy concepts to students from all of the communities and socio-economic circumstances served by the District; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District will develop partnerships with reputable financial institutions, such as California Credit Union, First Student Credit Union, non-profit, and/or community-based organizations that specialize in finance to assist students through supplemental programs, including but not limited to after-school programs, adult education, etc.